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MD, DAINIK BHASKAR GROUP

HEARTLAND HEADLINER

BECAUSE Just as 'Xerox' has become a synonym for photocopying and *thanda* often means Coca-Cola, in India's Hindi-speaking belt, Bhaskar has come to mean newspaper

BECAUSE with a readership of 66.3 million in Hindi, Marathi and Gujarati and their FM channel MY FM beaming from 30 radio stations in seven states, the brand covers the most populous and politically most powerful belt of the country

BECAUSE having grown from just one edition in Bhopal in 1977 to 62 editions in 11 states now, *Dainik Bhaskar* has proved that print journalism can be profitable

FUTURE-READY Sudhir Agarwal launched the Dainik Bhaskar App three years ago with a bold aim. In the print business, conventional wisdom dictates that 75 per cent revenue must come from advertisements and 25 per cent from subscriptions. Agarwal wants to turn that formula on its head with the app: 75 per cent revenue from subscriptions and the rest from advertisements

REGRETS Not being able to tap the English newspaper space. The Dainik Bhaskar Group launched three newspapers—*National Mail*, *DNA Mumbai* and *DB Post*—and had to withdraw from all of them. "The biggest lesson from the foray into English space was that you should stick to your core," says Agarwal

